Parent/Guardian module track

1. How Parents Track Students in Real Schools

In real-world systems, parents track students through **5 main areas**:

Academic Progress

Parents want to know:

- grades
- assignments
- exam results
- teacher feedback

Attendance

Parents check:

- daily attendance
- late arrivals
- absences

Fees and Payments

Parents track:

- school fees balance
- invoices
- payment history
- payment deadlines

Communication

Parents receive:

- announcements
- teacher messages
- school notices

Student Wellbeing

Parents see:

- health alerts
- discipline notifications
- activity participation

The system should present this information **in a simplified dashboard**.

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2. Parent Dashboard Structure

The parent portal should show **each linked child**.

Example:

```
Parent Dashboard
-------------------------
Child 1: Brian Mwangi
Grade 6

Child 2: Mercy Mwangi
Grade 3
```

Selecting a child opens the student's profile.

Main sections:

```
Overview
Academics
Attendance
Fees
Timetable
Assignments
Messages
Reports
Health
Transport
```

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3. Crucial Information Parents Should See

Student Profile

Basic identity information:

- student name

- class/grade
- admission number
- school house (optional)
- student photo

Parents should **not edit this**.

Attendance

Parents should see:

- present
- absent
- late
- excused absence

Example:

```
Attendance Today: Present
Monthly Attendance: 92%
Absences this term: 3
```

Alerts can notify parents immediately when a student is absent.

Academic Performance

Parents should see:

- assignments
- exam scores
- subject grades
- teacher remarks

Example:

```
Mathematics: 82%
English: 76%
Science: 89%
```

Also include:

- report cards

- academic progress trends

Homework and Assignments

Parents should see:

- assigned homework
- deadlines
- submission status

Example:

```
Math Assignment
Due: 14 March
Status: Submitted
```

Timetable

Parents can view:

- class schedule
- subject timetable
- exam timetable

Example:

```
Monday
Math – 8:00
English – 9:00
Science – 10:00
```

Fees and Finance

Parents must have full visibility into finances.

Information shared:

- fee invoices
- payment history
- outstanding balance
- payment deadlines
- downloadable receipts

Example:

```
Outstanding Balance: $200
Due Date: April 1
```

Parents may also **pay fees through the portal**.

Communication

Parents must be able to receive messages from:

- teachers
- school administration
- finance office

Examples:

```
School Announcements
Teacher Messages
Discipline Notifications
Fee Notices
```

Parents should also be able to **message teachers**, but within limits.

Health Information

Parents should see:

- health alerts
- nurse visits
- medical notes (if necessary)

Example:

```
Clinic Visit
Date: 10 March
Reason: Headache
Action: Sent home early
```

Transport Tracking (If School Has Buses)

Parents may see:

- assigned bus
- pickup location
- bus driver contact
- route schedule

Advanced systems may include **live GPS tracking**.

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4. Information That Should NOT Be Shared

To protect teachers and students, the parent module should **never expose internal records**.

Do NOT show:

Teacher Internal Notes

Example:

```
Student disruptive in class
Needs behavioral monitoring
```

These should remain internal.

Internal Disciplinary Investigations

Parents may receive **discipline alerts**, but not investigation reports.

Example shared:

```
Warning issued for classroom misconduct
```

But not:

```
Teacher complaint report
Witness statements
```

Staff Discussions

Teachers often discuss students internally.

Parents should **not see internal communication threads**.

Other Students' Data

Parents should only see **their own children**.

Never show:

- classmate grades
- attendance of other students
- disciplinary records of others

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5. Parent Access Permissions

Parents should have **read-only access** for most modules.

Example:

Module	Parent Access
Student profile	View
Attendance	View
Academics	View
Assignments	View
Fees	View + Pay
Messages	Send/Receive
Health	View
Transport	View

Parents cannot:

- edit grades
- change attendance
- modify discipline records

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6. Linking Parents to Students

Parent accounts must be **linked to students**.

Database structure:

```
parent_student_relationship
```

Fields:

```
parent_id
student_id
relationship_type
primary_guardian
emergency_contact
```

Example:

```
Parent: Jane Mwangi
Student: Brian Mwangi
Relationship: Mother
```

A parent may have **multiple students**.

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7. Notifications for Parents

Parents should receive alerts for important events.

Examples:

Attendance Alert

```
Brian Mwangi marked absent today.
```

Assignment Reminder

```
Math homework due tomorrow.
```

Fee Reminder

```
School fee due in 5 days.
```

Exam Results

```
Term 2 results published.
```

Alerts should come through:

- app notifications
- email
- SMS
- WhatsApp (optional)

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8. Parent Comfort Features

To make parents comfortable using the system:

Simple UI

Parents should see **clear and simple information**.

Avoid overwhelming them with school administrative details.

Mobile-Friendly Portal

Most parents will use **phones**.

The parent module should function well on mobile.

Language Support

Some schools may allow:

```
English
Swahili
French
```

Secure Messaging

Parent-teacher communication should happen **inside the platform**, not personal phone numbers.

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9. Teacher Comfort and Protection

Teachers should feel safe using the system.

So the system should:

- prevent parents from editing academic records
- limit messaging hours
- log all communications
- allow teachers to escalate issues to administrators

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10. Student Comfort

Students should not feel constantly monitored.

Parents should not see:

- real-time classroom activity
- internal teacher remarks
- behavioral observation notes

Only **finalized information** should be shared.

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11. Ideal Parent Module Layout

Example:

```
Parent Portal
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My Children
Messages
Announcements
Fees & Payments
Academic Reports
Attendance
Homework
Transport
Health Records
Notifications
```

Each child has a **separate dashboard**.

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12. Advanced Feature (Highly Recommended)

You can add **Student Progress Insights**.

Example:

```
Brian is performing above class average in Mathematics.
Brian attendance improved this month.
```

This helps parents **support their children better**.